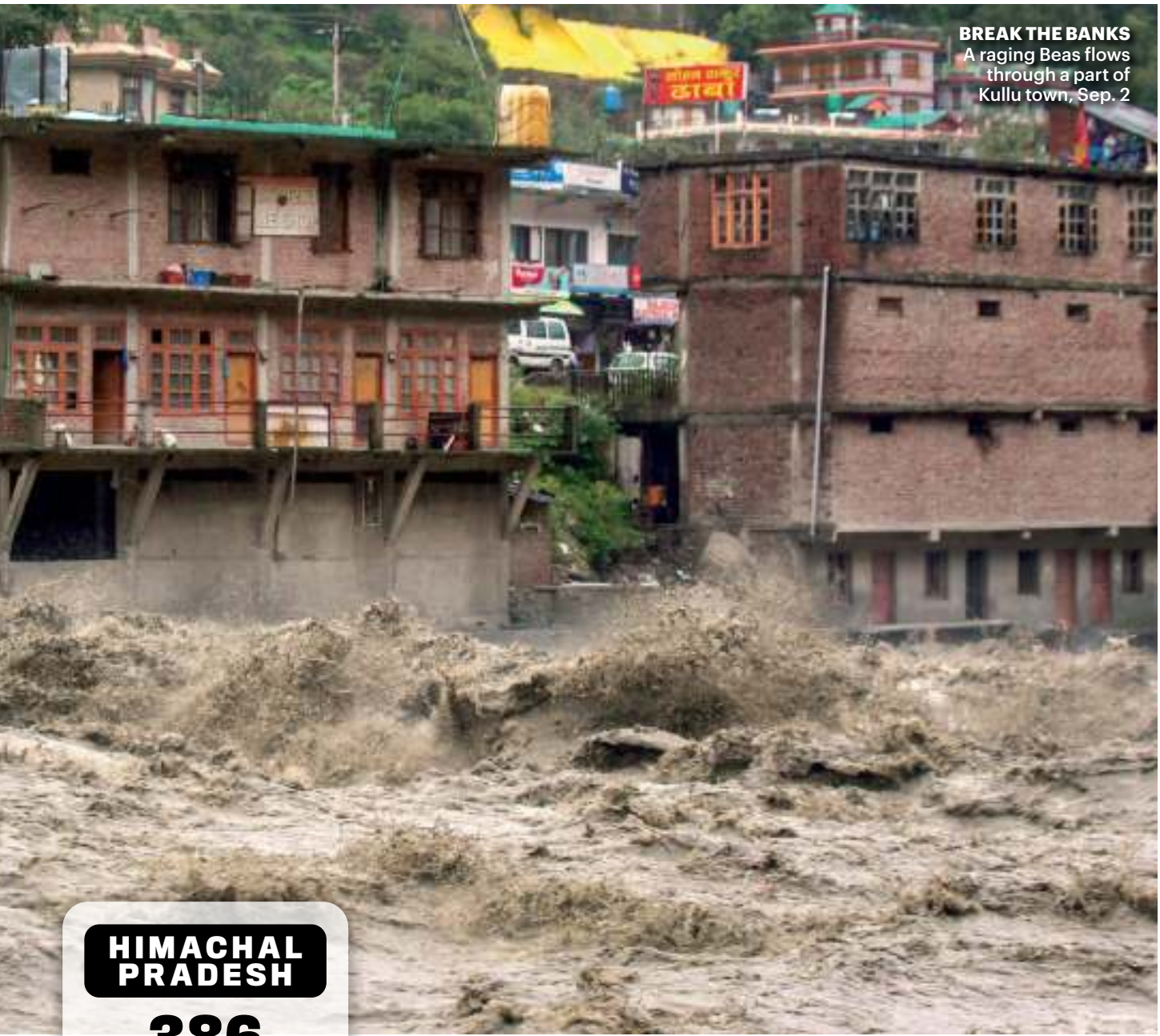


BREAK THE BANKS
A raging Beas flows through a part of Kullu town, Sep. 2

HIMACHAL PRADESH

386
DEATH TOLL

₹4,100 cr.
OFFICIAL LOSS ESTIMATE

991 mm
AGGREGATE RAINFALL*

44%
EXCESS RAIN

* For the period Jun. 1-Sept. 15, 2025; Source: IMD

outflows to Haryana. Cut to August-end and with water levels at the dams reaching the danger mark, the BBMB was releasing 65,000 cusecs from Bhakra and 80,000 cusecs from Pong dam every day. Faulty weather forecasts left operators with little room to stagger discharges. "The release from Bhakra and Pong this year has been the highest in history," confirmed BBMB chairman Manoj Tripathi. Between July 1 and September 5, the Beas alone received 11.7 billion cubic metres (BCM) of inflow, compared to, say, the 9.5 BCM for the same period in 2023 (when the last flood took place). The result: nearly three score dead and about half a million acres of farmland laid to waste. Wilted crops of cotton, paddy and sugarcane are everywhere.

In Sultanpur Lodhi, farmer Baldev Singh points to his flattened stalks of paddy: "We have spent thousands on seeds and pesticides, and now everything is gone in one night. Even if the water recedes, the silt has choked the fields." Across Gurdaspur, Tarn Taran, Amritsar, Jalandhar and Kapurthala, the stories repeat themselves, as families complain of their savings getting wiped out, and prospects looking grim for the kharif procurement season. Officials peg the losses at over Rs 12,000 crore, but farm unions argue the figure could be nearly double once input costs and damage to farm machinery are included.

On September 8, Punjab chief minister